

- Click and hold down the mouse button to begin drawing.
- Drag the mouse and draw the shape you desire.
- To end your drawing, release the mouse button.

2.3 Inferences In SketchUp

One of the most terrific things about SketchUp is this predictive ability called the “Inference Engine”. Once you’ve mastered using this, you can start drawing really quickly for almost everything you draw in SketchUp can be made using the Inference Engine.

The Inference Engine

The Inference Engine is a geometric analysis mechanism that infers points (relative to other points) and gives you smart tips and visual cues as you draw. It locates (“infers” in SketchUp lingo) points from other points in your model, flashing cues like “Endpoint”, “Midpoint” and so on to keep you on track and in touch with what exactly you’re drawing. This enables a hassle-free drawing experience, and eliminates the potential pitfalls of attempting to work in a 3D space while actually using a 2D screen. These cues are what they call tooltips.

Cute Cues

As you work on your model, SketchUp’s Inference Engine automatically displays ToolTip cues to help you identify any significant points or relevant geometry. This helps you draw better and more accurately. Besides, specific colours are used by the inference engine to show the type of inference it displays. (In short, ToolTips + Coloured Lines = Inference Engine).

Types of Inferences

SketchUp expedites the modelling process with three main types of inferences:

1. Point Inferences
2. Linear Inferences
3. Planar Inferences

Sometimes, two or more of these could combine together to form a complex inference.